

CHAPTER #13

```
vivek@nixcraft-asus:~$ distro=("redhat" "debian" "gentoo")
vivek@nixcraft-asus:~$ echo "${distro[0]}"
redhat
vivek@nixcraft-asus:~$ echo "${distro[2]}"
gentoo
vivek@nixcraft-asus:~$ len=${#distro[0]}
vivek@nixcraft-asus:~$ echo "$len"
3
vivek@nixcraft-asus:~$ for (( i=0; i<$len; i++ ))
> do
>     echo "${distro[$i]}"
> done
redhat
debian
gentoo
vivek@nixcraft-asus:~$
```

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Strings, Arrays, And Numbers

Learn about the basics of strings, numbers and arrays in command line

Strings and Numbers: Parameter Expansion

A shell has various features to work around strings and numbers. Many parameter expansions are performed to get specific string operations. Let's start with basic parameters first.

Basic parameters

Shell variables can be written as simple as: `$a` or `${a}`

Though in general, it has no significance on expansion. Still, on the command line, it can be confusing to shell when a variable is placed adjacent to other texts. Braces are used here to separate variables from other texts.